

Skyra — White Paper

Draft — Work in Progress

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There is a pattern in the history of technology. Not in the technology itself — in the business around it. Every time a new platform emerges, the people who build it end up with more than the people who use it. The product improves. The deal doesn't.

Every time the game changes, something doesn't.

It started with the scroll.

Sometime around 2009, engineers at Facebook discovered something that would reshape human behavior more profoundly than any technology since television. If you removed the natural stopping points — the page breaks, the end of the feed, the moment where you'd normally put the magazine down — people wouldn't stop. They'd just keep going. Infinite scroll wasn't a feature. It was a trap. And it worked perfectly.

The game changed. The rules didn't.

What followed was the greatest data harvesting operation in human history. Every like, every pause, every share, every moment of hesitation before you kept scrolling — captured, labeled, fed back into an algorithm designed to do one thing: keep you there longer. The product wasn't the social network. The product was you. Your attention, your behavior, your emotional state — packaged and sold to the highest bidder, a thousand times a day, without your knowledge.

You trusted the platform with your relationships. You trusted it with your time. You trusted it with the parts of yourself you shared only with friends — your humor, your grief, your politics, your 2am loneliness. That trust was the inventory. That trust was what they sold.

For fifteen years this was the deal. You got connection, entertainment, a window into the world. They got everything else. The behavioral data. The emotional fingerprints. And most personally:

They got you...

And they got rich... Richer than almost anyone in history.

We know what that did to people. We have the data now. Teenage depression spiked. Anxiety became an epidemic. An entire generation grew up with their self-worth algorithmically managed — not by accident, but by design. The scroll was engineered to be addictive. The like button was engineered to create dependency. The feed was engineered to make you feel just bad enough about yourself to keep coming back. They knew. The internal research said so...

They shipped it anyway.

By the time anyone in power notices, the damage is done. By the time the hearings happen, the companies are too big to touch. By the time the laws are written, the technology has already moved on. In April 2018, Senators asked Mark Zuckerberg how Facebook makes money. He smiled and said they run ads. The hearing ended. Social media still hasn't been meaningfully regulated. An entire generation's mental health — documented, researched, undeniable — and the answer was nothing.

Then on November 30th 2022, ChatGPT launched.

In the last 4 years, a handful of companies have learned more about how humans think than anyone in history. You paid for that with your data. You saw none of the return.

That's not an accident. That's still the business model.

The game changed. The rules didn't.

Every conversation you've had, every question you've asked, every problem you've worked through with an AI assistant — that signal went somewhere. It made their model better. It made their company more valuable. And you got a free chatbot.

This time the trust goes deeper. You're not sharing what you liked or how long you scrolled. You're sharing how you think. The problems you can't solve. The fears you haven't told anyone. The ambitions you're not sure you deserve. Every conversation with their AI is another data point in the most detailed psychological profile ever built — on you, specifically. And it is being built right now, every time you type.

This is the deal we all agreed to without reading the terms. And for a while it felt fair — the product was good enough that the trade didn't sting.

But somewhere along the way, the scale of what was being taken started to become visible. The targeted ad that knew you were pregnant before you told your family. The feed that knew you were lonely at 2am. The recommendation that knew you were drifting from your faith, your politics, your sense of self — and nudged you further. The algorithm didn't just observe you. It learned you. And then it used what it learned to keep you compliant, keep you engaged, keep you producing data.

You were never the user. You were always the product.

You could have left. Some people did. But the cost was real. This was how an entire generation maintained relationships. The group chat. The birthday post. The meme your

friend sent at 2am that made you feel less alone. Your cousin sending you a TikTok and you couldn't even watch it in the browser — they made you download the app first, one more small surrender, one more hook. These platforms had rewired human connection itself. Opting out didn't mean missing entertainment. It meant missing each other. That's not a small thing. That was the first trap — and it was a good one.

The first trap rewrote the fabric of human connection.

Now they are rewriting the fabric of human productivity.

And this time you can't opt out. Not really. Not anymore. If you're not using these tools you are falling behind — in your career, your business, your ability to compete. The cost of not participating is no longer a missed birthday post. It's economic. It's professional. The leverage they have over you just got much bigger. And the data they're collecting just got much more intimate.

They're getting better at this every single day. The models are improving. The harvesting is getting more precise. The profile they're building of you is getting richer.

And you're still giving it away for free.

Why?

Because there is no other alternative (TINA).

There was no system that put you at the center. No platform that kept your data on yours. No AI that learned who you actually are — your habits, your patterns, your emotional fingerprints — without feeding you an ad for it a moment later. No system that worked for you without asking you to trust it.

There wasn't one. So I'm building it.



A few years from now, the models will have reached a cruising altitude.

Progress will still be made. New capabilities will still emerge. But the rate of change will slow — not because the engineers stopped trying, but because of physics. You cannot train a frontier model without building a small power plant to run it. The compute required is growing faster than the gains it produces. Diminishing returns, at civilizational scale.

And when the dust settles, the general models will look roughly the same. Not because the teams building them aren't talented — they are extraordinary — but because they all trained on the same data. The internet. Books. Code repositories. And increasingly, you. Every general model ingested the same corpus. They will converge on similar capabilities the way every television converged on the same screen size. The differentiation will be at the margins.

That convergence matters. Because it means the next wave of value isn't in the model. It's in what surrounds the model.

While the models plateau, the hardware won't.

In 1956, one gigabyte of storage cost two million dollars. Today it costs two cents. That's not a gradual improvement — that's a complete rewrite of what's possible. Processing power has followed the same curve. The chip in your pocket today would have been a national security asset forty years ago. The hardware that runs the largest models today will fit in your home in a decade. The compute that requires a data center in 2025 will run on a device you own in 2035.

This is the pattern. It has never broken.

What that means for AI: the inference that currently costs these companies millions per day to run will become cheap enough to run locally. The models that require server farms will run on hardware you own, in your house, under your control. The latency of a round trip to the cloud disappears. The privacy risk of your data crossing a wire disappears. The dependency on a subscription to a company whose incentives may not align with yours — disappears.

Skyra is built for that world.

Not as a bet against the current one — the cloud is necessary today and will be for years. But as a system designed to run where the trajectory of hardware points: on yours. Local first. Private by architecture, not by policy. A system that gets more capable as the hardware you already own gets more powerful — not as someone else's server farm gets bigger.

The extraction model only works if you need them. If the inference moves local, you don't.

That's the window. And it opens whether they want it to or not.



Skyra runs on your devices. All of them.

Not as an app you download. As a layer that lives across your hardware — your phone, your laptop, your home machine — each one a shard of the same system. Each shard knows what it's capable of. Your phone handles voice. Your laptop handles reasoning. Your home machine handles memory and the heavier work. They coordinate. They divide labor. They operate as one.

Add a new device and the system gets stronger. More compute. More capability. A faster response on the heavier jobs. Remove a device — or lose it, or shut it down — and the system degrades gracefully. The other shards pick up what they can. Nothing breaks. Nothing is lost. The system was designed for the real world, where hardware comes and goes and nothing is perfectly reliable.

This is what it means to be private by architecture. Your data never leaves the network you own. There is no server on the other side of a login screen holding your memories hostage. If you cancel nothing, delete nothing, and walk away — your data is still yours. It's on your hardware. It always was.

Skyra learns you the way a good assistant learns you — not from a form you filled out, but from working with you. Every conversation, every task, every correction. She builds a model of how you think, what you care about, how you work best. That model lives on your hardware. It is not a profile in a database somewhere. It is not inventory. It is yours.

And it compounds. The longer she runs, the more she knows. The more she knows, the less you have to explain. Over time the overhead of working with AI — the prompting, the context-setting, the repetition — collapses. She already knows. You just talk.



There is one more piece.

Your data — the patterns Skyra has learned about you — has value beyond your own household. Companies building the next generation of models need signal. Real signal. Not scraped text. Not synthetic data. The messy, specific, human signal of how people actually think and work and feel. That signal is sitting on your devices right now. It has been for years. The difference is — until now, someone else was collecting it.

Skyra makes it possible to contribute that signal without giving it away.

Using zero-knowledge proofs, your data never leaves your hardware. A company that wants to query collective intelligence — to understand, say, how people react to financial stress, or what triggers creative breakthroughs, or how users actually navigate a new product — submits a query to the network. The network runs the computation locally, across thousands of participating devices, and returns an aggregate answer. No individual's data is ever exposed. No company ever sees your records. The proof is mathematical, not promised.

And every dollar paid to query that network goes back to the people whose hardware ran the computation. Back to you.

This is what the deal should have always been. You contribute signal. You get paid for it.

Participation is entirely optional. Skyra works exactly the same whether you join the network or not. Your data stays local either way. The network is an opt-in for people who want to reclaim value from what they were already giving away for free. If that's not you, nothing changes. No pressure, no degraded experience, no dark pattern designed to push you in.

That's the other thing that's different this time.

Your privacy is not a policy — it's a proof.



I'm building this in public.

No funding round. No pitch deck. No ask. If what you just read made you feel something — if you recognized the pattern, if you've thought about this too — come watch it get built.

Discord: <https://discord.com/channels/1478802859356061967/1478802861365399594>

GitHub: <https://github.com/m-scanlon/tony-stark-was-able-to-build-this-in-a-cave>